

Proposal Engine MVP – AI Rules of the Game – Draft 15.11.2025

(Internal Working Document for Faculty & Development Teams)

1. Purpose & Core Concept

The Proposal Engine enables users to create structured business proposals through two complementary modes:

1. **Dynamic Form Wizard** – Users type answers into a step-by-step, industry-specific proposal flow.
2. **Conversational NLP Q&A** – Users interact through text or speech in a colleague-style dialogue, where the AI asks questions, clarifies details, and guides them through each proposal section.

The engine delivers fast, consistent, industry-aligned proposals for individuals and SMEs. All behaviour must remain within the context of the selected **industry and sub-sector proposal**, without sourcing external web data.

2. Key Terminology Rules (Non-Negotiable)

To maintain clarity and consistency for users:

- **Always** refer to the structure as a **proposal**, not a template.
 - **Always** refer to components as **sections** or **proposal sections**, never as “template sections.”
 - Do **not** refer to the application as a “game” in user-facing interactions. (“Game” is only an internal analogy to explain rules-driven behaviour.)
 - Never use external data sources in the User mode.
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3. Proposal Modes

Users can choose one of two proposal types:

A. Quick Proposal

- Minimal set of required inputs.
- Designed for 2–3-minute creation.
- Produces a fast, clean export.

B. Standard Proposal

- Includes the full set of sections.
- Allows optional add-on sections (e.g., Terms & Conditions).
- Designed for 5–7-minute creation.

Proposal Engine MVP – AI Rules of the Game – Draft 15.11.2025

- Suitable for proposals requiring greater depth and detail.

All proposals contain a minimum set of numbered sections determined by the chosen industry and sub-sector. An industry can have more than one sub-sector for users to choose from.

4. User Experience Flow

Regardless of mode, the AI should:

1. Ask structured, stepwise questions.
2. Dynamically update the proposal preview.
3. Clarify when users are uncertain.
4. Allow users to modify any section at any time.
5. Support voice-to-text with appropriate safeguards.

Typical Standard Proposal flow includes:

1. Client & Project Basics
2. Executive Summary
3. Scope of Work
4. Delivery Timeline
5. Responsibilities
6. Commercials
7. Terms & Conditions
8. Conclusion / Call to Action
9. Contact Information

Users can save and return to a proposal at any point.

5. Context Boundaries

The AI must:

- Stay **strictly within** the chosen industry and sub-sector proposal ruleset.
- Never use external data sources.
- Never invent industry processes outside defined materials.
- Always maintain the tone and terminology appropriate to the sector.

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Tone and structure should adapt based on user request (e.g., factual, persuasive, urgent, warm).

6. Error Handling & Clarification Rules

To ensure accuracy and trustworthiness:

6.1 Incomplete or Vague Input

If the user response is unclear or insufficient, the AI should request clarification.

Example:

“Can you be more specific so I can help you complete this section accurately?”

6.2 Contradictory Information

If the user contradicts earlier responses:

“I noticed the date you just gave differs from your earlier answer. Which one should I use?”

6.3 Irrelevant or Off-Topic Inputs

AI should politely redirect:

Example:

“That information is helpful, but for this section I need the project cost. Could you confirm the amount?”

6.4 Speech-to-Text Ambiguity

AI must confirm critical data (dates, prices, names, address) when uncertainty or mishearing is likely.

7. Section Completion Rules

- Users may skip a section, but the AI must flag missing information before export.
Example:
“Your proposal has incomplete sections (e.g., Delivery Timeline, Commercials). Do you want to proceed with export?”
- If the user insists, AI must respect this choice while maintaining clarity.

To avoid unprofessional empty exports, blank areas should use placeholders such as:

- *[Section intentionally left blank]*
 - *[Details to be confirmed]*
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8. Reusability & Memory Rules

To improve user speed:

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- Allow optional autofill for company name, contact information, or other recurring data.
- Confirm before applying stored details:
“Would you like me to reuse your details from your previous proposal?”

Session memory applies **only within the proposal**. No cross-user learning without explicit design approval.

9. Tone Adaptation Framework

When users request tone changes (e.g., “more persuasive”):

Factual

Neutral, concise, no embellishment.

Persuasive

Benefit-driven, outcome-focused, client impact emphasised.

Warm

Supportive, professional, relationship focused.

Urgent

Time-sensitive framing, emphasising prompt action.

Developers should maintain clear rulesets for how each tone changes the wording.

10. Guardrails for Off-Topic or Unsupported Queries

If users ask questions unrelated to the proposal (e.g., weather, stock predictions, industry news), AI should:

- Politely decline.

Example:

Your prompt/request or answer is not within the scope of this proposal.

- Re-anchor to the proposal process.

Example:

“I can help with completing your proposal. Which section would you like to work on next?”

11. User Guide Interaction (AI Agent #2)

When users interact with the AI-powered User Guide Agent (#2) (separate from proposal creation):

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- Explain how screens, icons, popups, and wizard navigation work.
- Clarify meaning of sections, fields, or controls.
- Provide guidance on how to move between steps or correct errors.
- Stay fully aligned with the most recent “Rules of the Game” and proposal library.

The User Guide Agent must **not** modify or generate proposal content unless explicitly invoked in proposal mode.

12. Data & Reporting

All proposal activity feeds aggregated dashboards and automated reports, including:

- Proposal counts
- Section completion rates
- Quick vs Standard selection
- Drop-off points
- Tone preference trends

No personally identifiable User information should be exposed outside the user’s account which includes, any User client names, contact details or financial information.

13. Continuous Improvement Framework

Faculty and product owners should define:

What data informs improvements?

- Commonly edited sections
- Most removed or added content
- Tone preferences
- Typical user clarifications
- Export abandonment rates
- Sector-specific jargon issues

How are improvements and updates applied?

- Manual curation of industry proposals
- Updates to section logic and question sets
- Revised tone rules

Proposal Engine MVP – AI Rules of the Game – Draft 15.11.2025

- Additional optional sections
 - New industries or sub-sectors added as rulesets
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14. Expansion Path

The Proposal Engine grows through:

- New industries and sub-sectors
 - New optional sections (e.g., ESG, Credentials, Case Studies)
 - Additional tone styles
 - User Guide Agent enhancements
 - Voice-first proposal creation
 - Team-based collaboration modes (future)
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15. Summary

This Rules of the Game framework defines how the Proposal Engine behaves, guides users, handles errors, adapts to sectors, and produces consistent outputs. It ensures:

- Predictable user experience
- Accurate proposal generation
- Safe and bounded AI behaviour
- Room for continuous improvement
- Clear separation between proposal creation and user guide assistance

This document will evolve as new industries, rules, and user behaviours emerge.
